

**Your product
isn't the
problem.**

**Your
positioning is.**

You built something great.

So why is nobody paying attention?

Months of runway gone, a product you're proud of — and a market that scrolls right past it.

WHAT EVERYONE GETS WRONG

THE MYTH

"Build a better product and the customers will come."

THE REALITY

Clarity wins attention long before quality does.

HERE'S THE DEAL

**By the end of this you'll
know how to make the
right people stop
scrolling — in 2 weeks,
not 6 months.**

**In the AI era,
anyone can build
software.**

**The moat is the
story.**

Positioning

/ noun / The deliberate choice of **who** you're building for and **why** you're different — settled before a word of the story gets written.

The 3C model

C1 Customer

The exact person you're for — not "everyone".

C2 Contrast

The one way you're visibly different.

C3 Clarity

Said in plain words they'd repeat.

01

Name the one person you're for.

Write their job, their budget, and the exact moment they feel the pain. If it fits everyone, it fits no one.

From fog to focus



Diagnose

Ask what you're too close to see.



Position

Settle brand and product together.



Build around it

Ship with the story already set.

4 FAST FIXES

Tighten your message today

-
- 1** Cut every word a 12-year-old wouldn't say.
 - 2** Lead with their problem, not your product.
 - 3** Swap adjectives for a number or a name.
 - 4** Say who it's not for. Out loud.
-

OLD WAY VS. NEW WAY

PRODUCT-FIRST

Build for months → then figure out the story → hope it lands.

BRAND-FIRST

Get clear on who and why → then build around it.

Writing your one-liner

DON'T

"AI-powered solutions to supercharge your startup."

DO

"We clarify your identity, then build around it."

THE TRANSFORMATION

BEFORE

"We help teams do more."



AFTER

"Ship your seed-stage launch in 2 weeks."

What happens, when

- **Days 1–3**

Diagnose: audience, problem, why you.

- **Days 4–8**

Position: brand + product direction, settled.

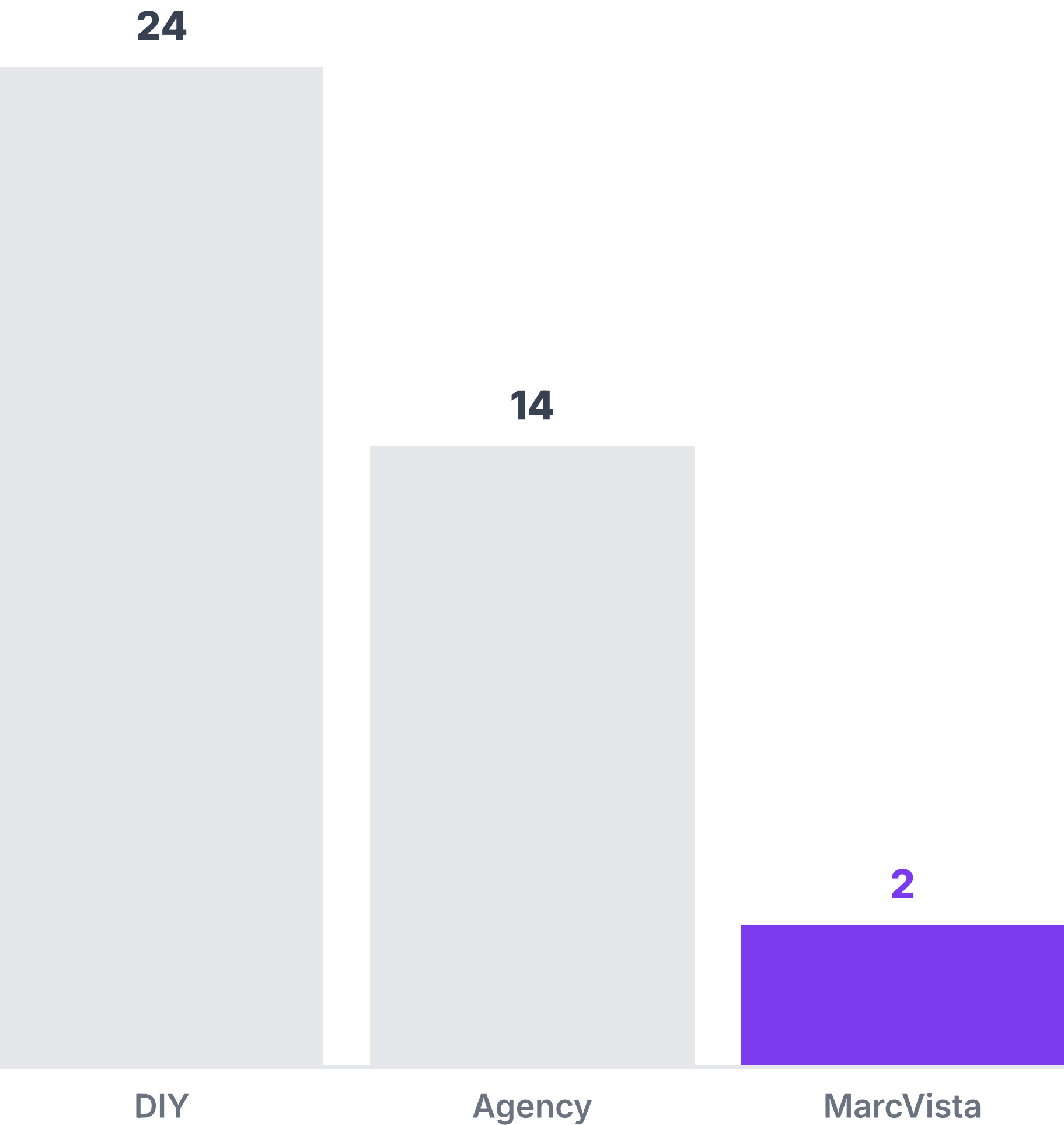
- **Days 9–14**

Articulate: messaging and a live website.

73%

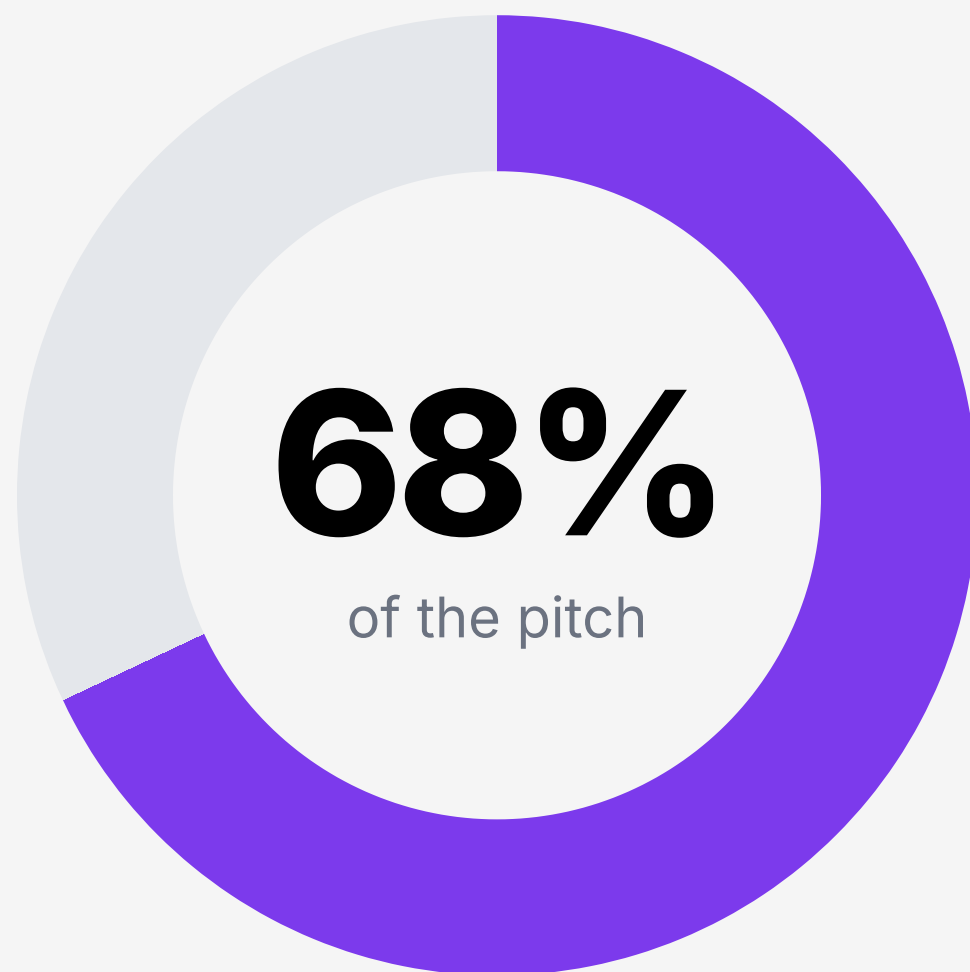
of startups that fail cite **no market need** — a positioning problem, not a product one.

Weeks, not months



WHERE IT SHOWS UP

Investors notice



of a first meeting is spent on "who is this for?"

BY THE NUMBERS

What clarity buys

2 wk from kickoff to a sharp story

3x faster sales conversations after

1 message the whole team can repeat

Every fuzzy word costs you

Saw your post

10,000

Understood it

3,400

Clicked through 820

Booked
a call 90

BUILD IN THIS ORDER

The clarity stack

Story

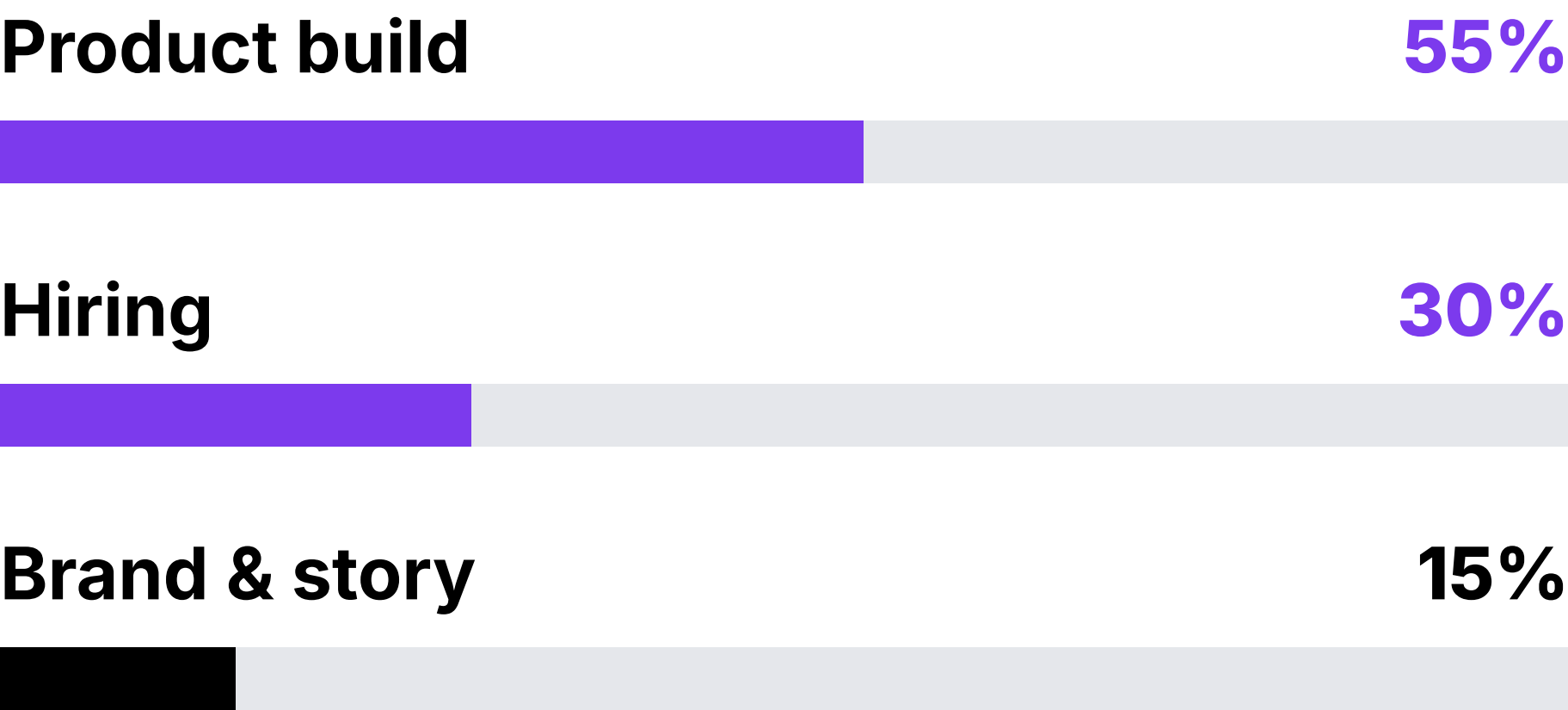
Messaging

Website

Product

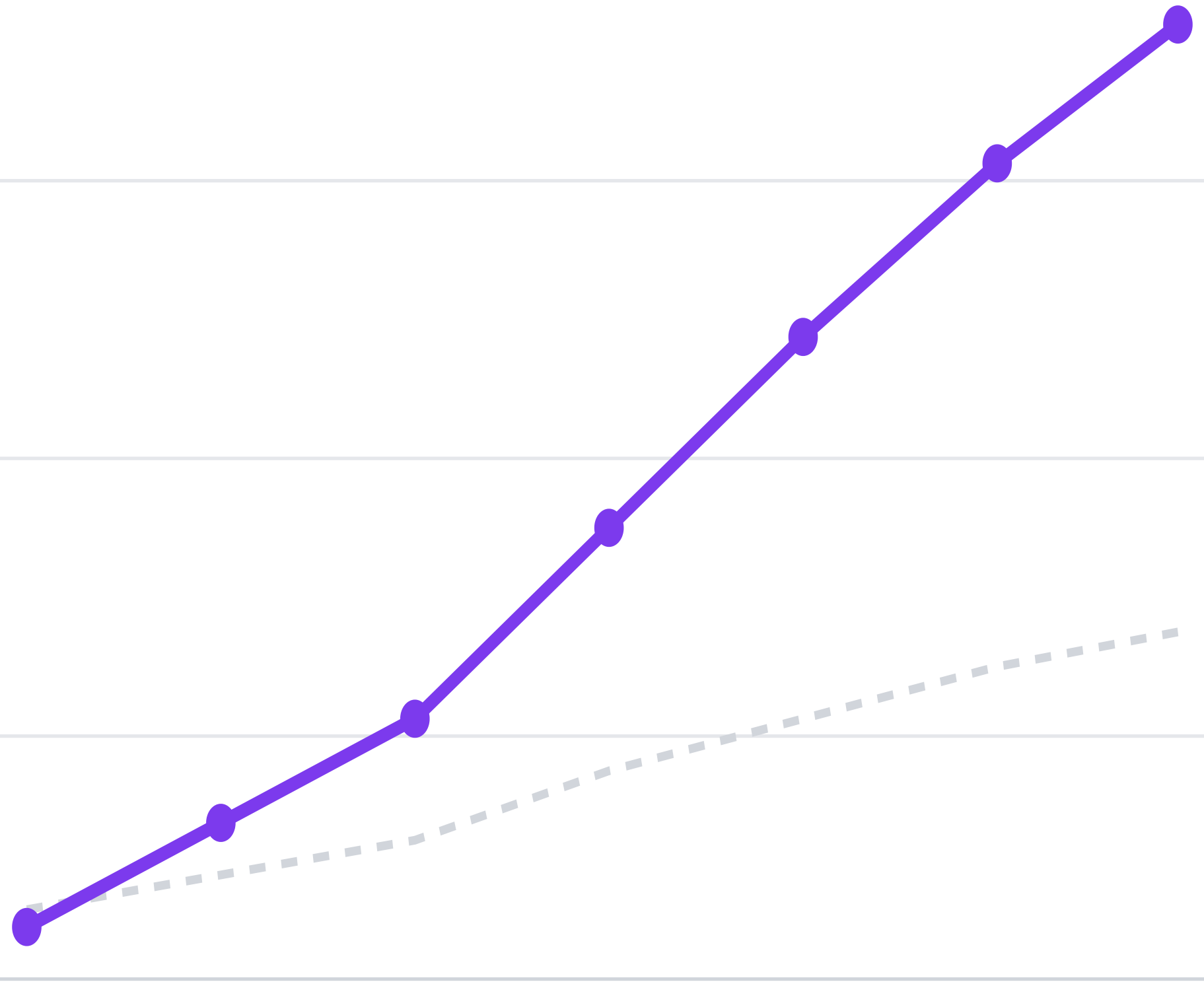
WHERE THE BUDGET GOES

A typical seed spend

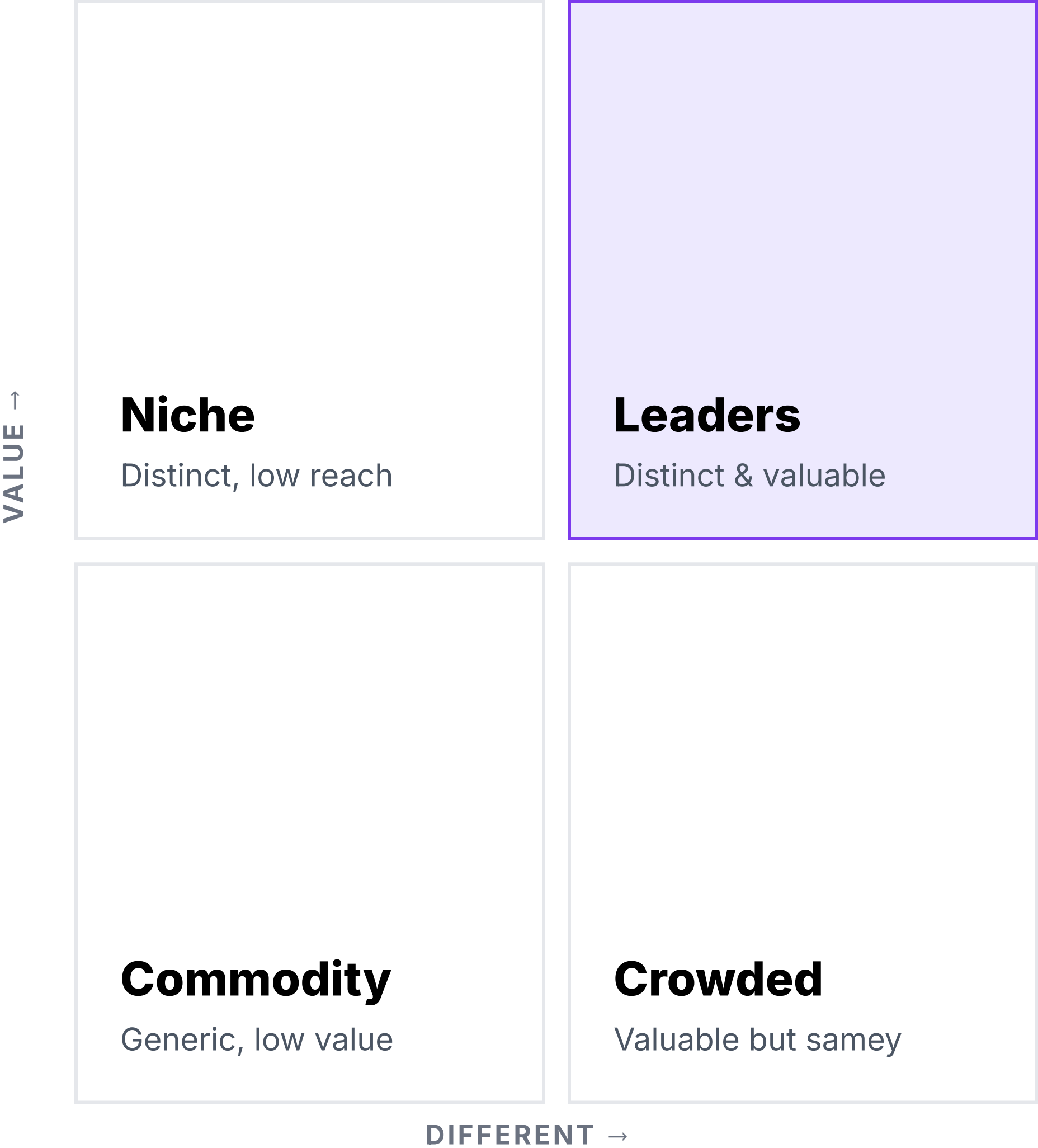


Most founders underfund the one thing that does the selling.

Inbound starts compounding



Value x differentiation



Four things that change



3x

faster sales calls



2 wk

to a sharp story



1

message, repeated by all

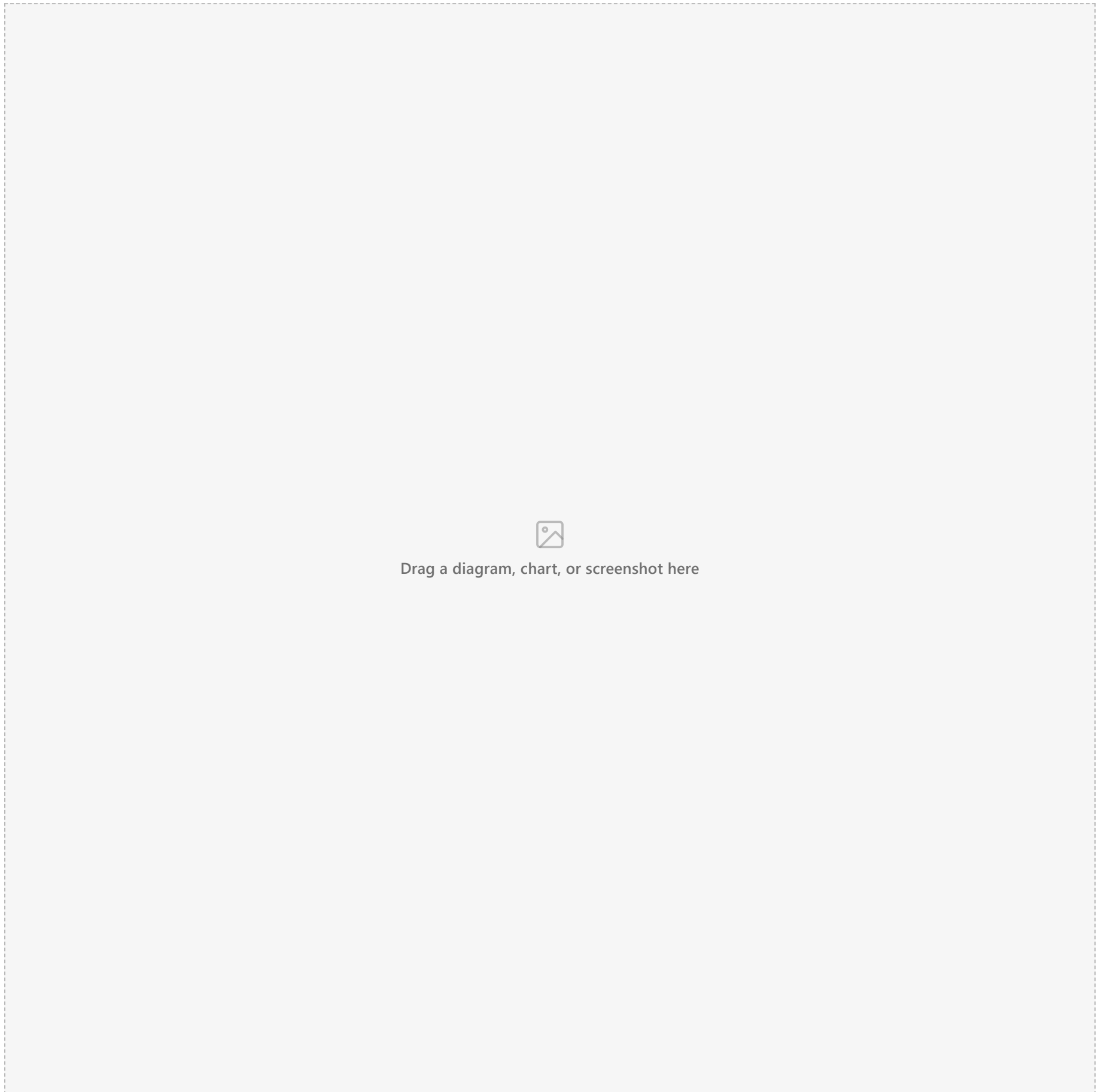


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hype words left

SHOW, DON'T TELL

Drop in your diagram



A one-line caption tells the reader what the visual shows.

MINI CASE STUDY

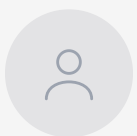
SuperFi · fintech

14 days

Came in with a hard launch deadline and a generic story. Left with a sharp one-liner, a live site, and a launch that shipped **on schedule**.



They got us clear on who we were building for in two weeks — something we'd circled for months.



Founder, SuperFi

A confused mind never buys.

— the oldest rule in marketing, still undefeated

SAVE THIS

Your positioning checklist

- ✓ One person it's for — named
- ✓ One way you're different — visible
- ✓ One line they'd repeat — in plain words
- ✓ Zero hype words — none

IF YOU REMEMBER ONE THING

**Clarify the brand
first. Then build the
product around it.**



Found this useful?

Follow **@marcvista** for plain-English positioning, and comment "**CLARITY**" for the free sprint guide.

Book a positioning call →

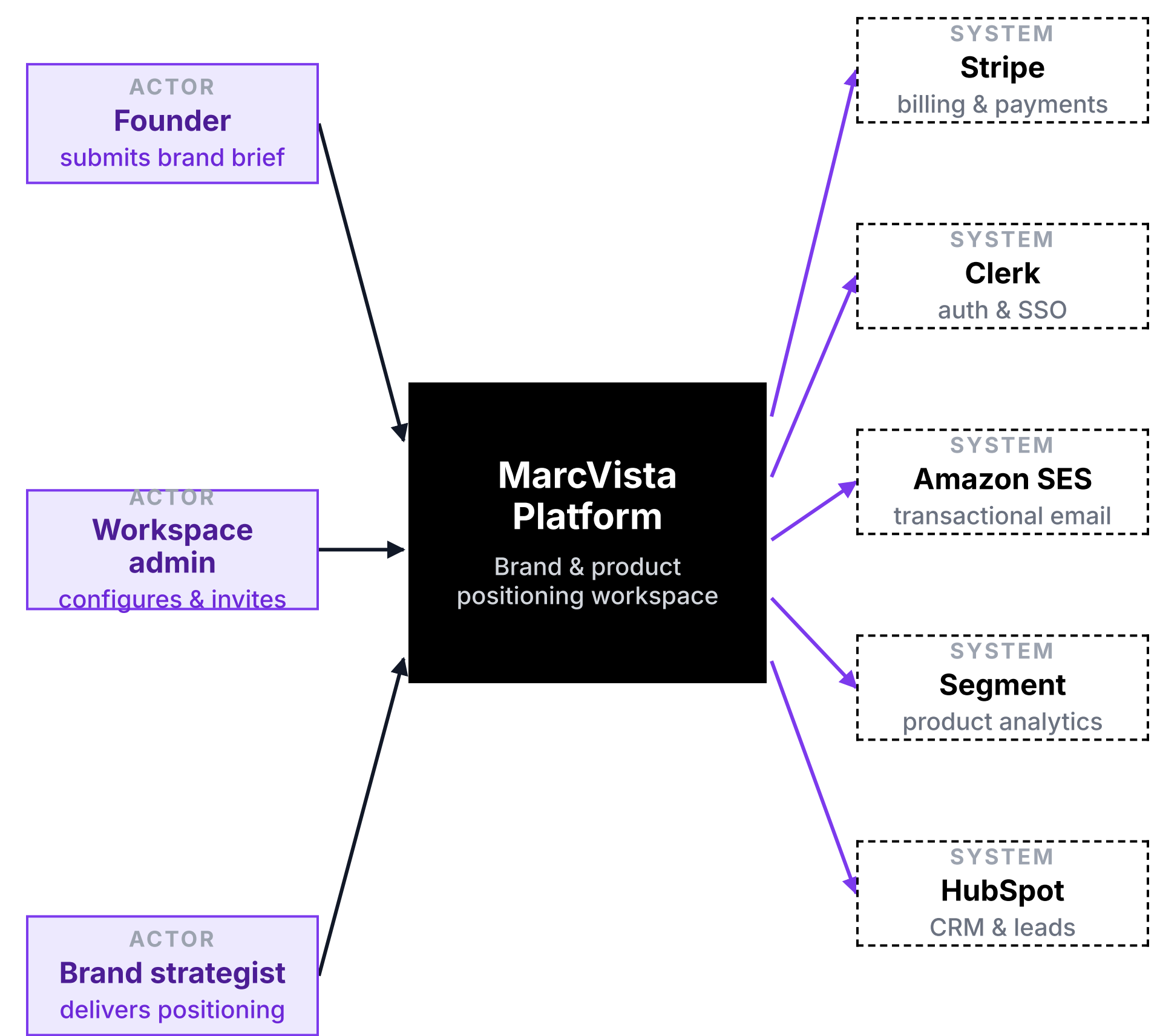
APPENDIX

Technical & business diagrams

A reusable reference set — architecture, data flow, activity, sequence, schema, process and planning views for the MarcVista platform.

System context

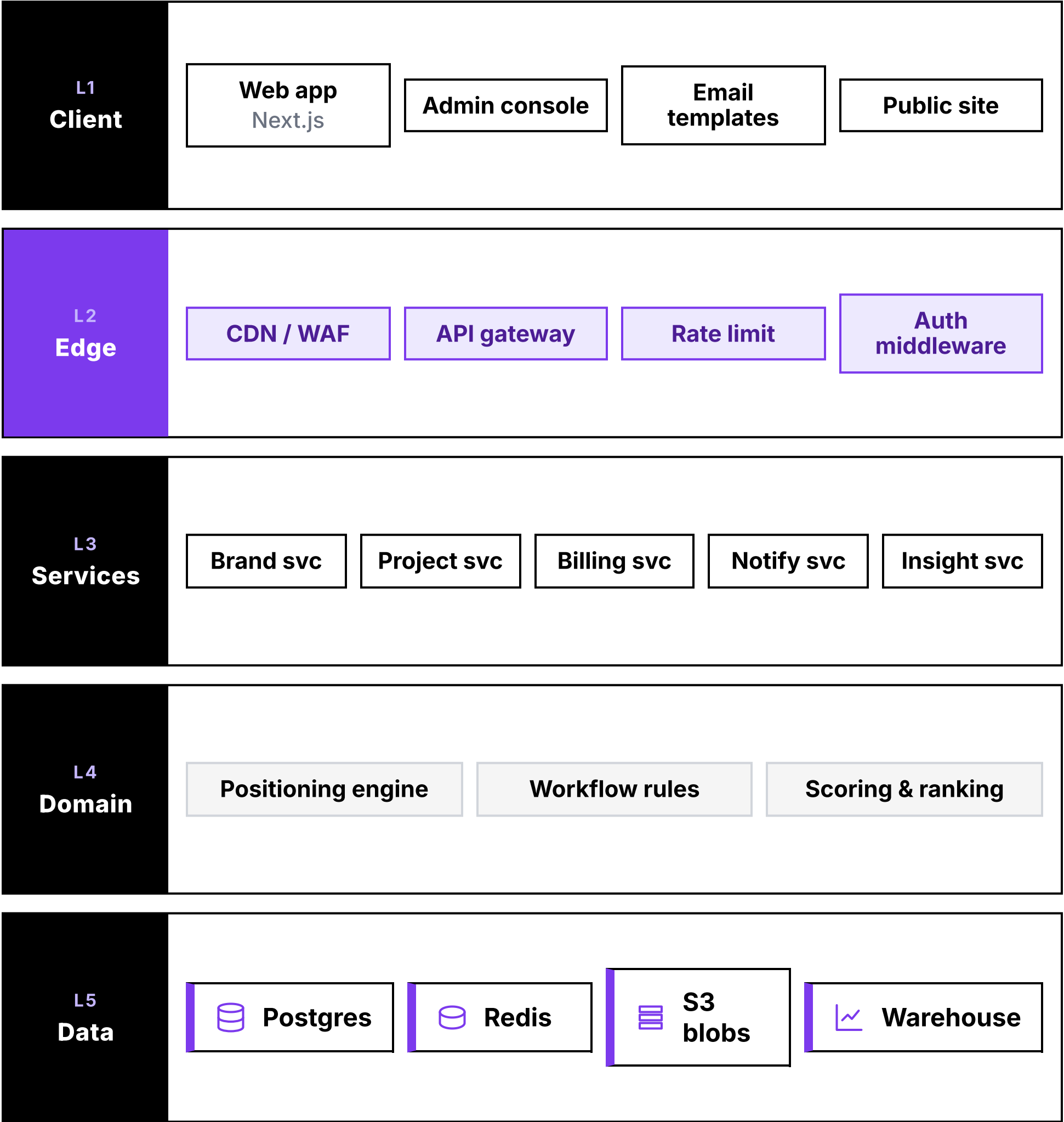
Who and what the platform talks to — actors on the left, external systems on the right.



Person / actor External system System in scope

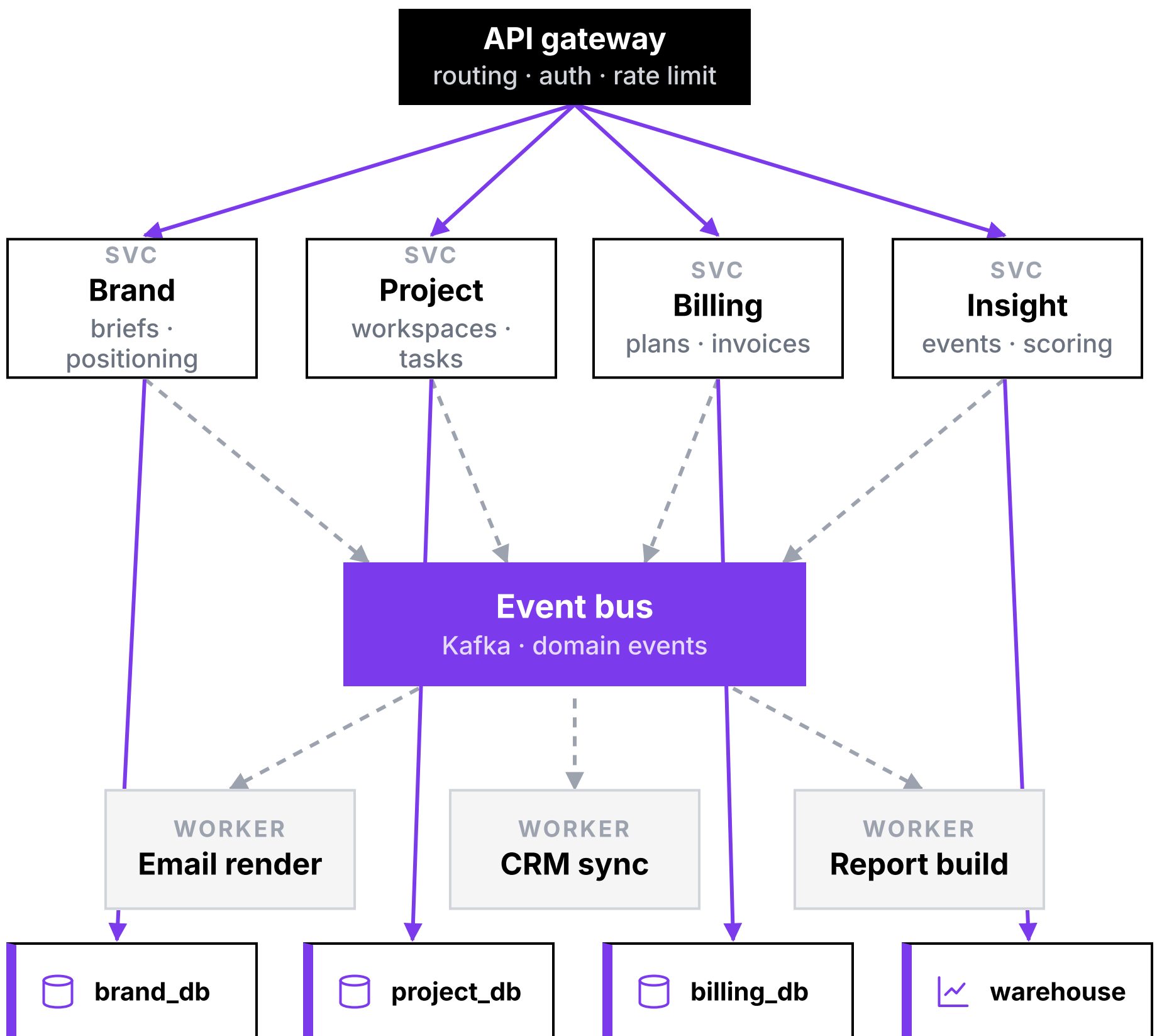
Layered architecture

Five tiers from client to data — each layer only depends on the one below it.



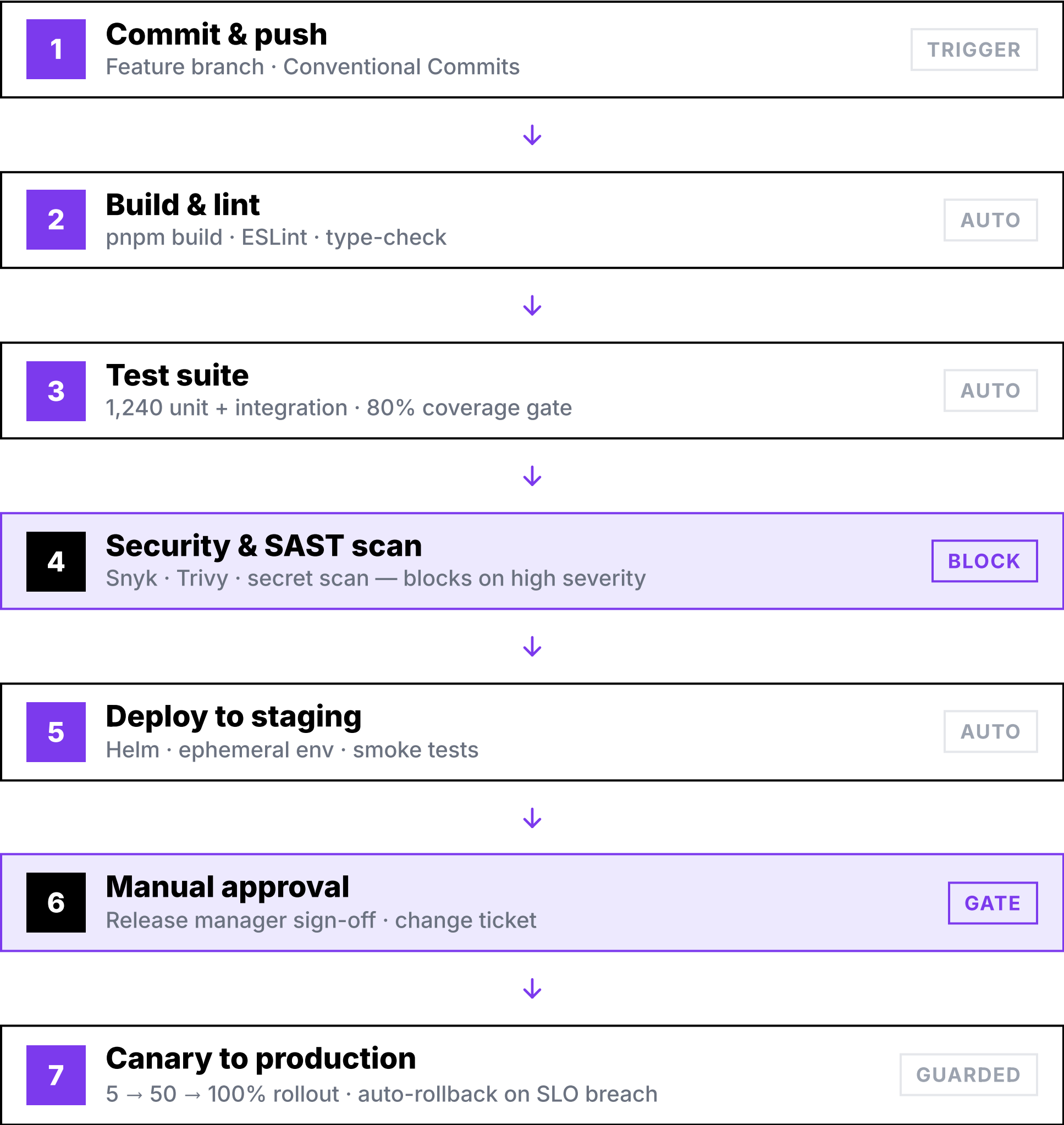
Microservices & messaging

Gateway fans out to bounded-context services; async work flows over an event bus.



CI/CD pipeline

Every commit walks the same gates from push to a guarded canary release.



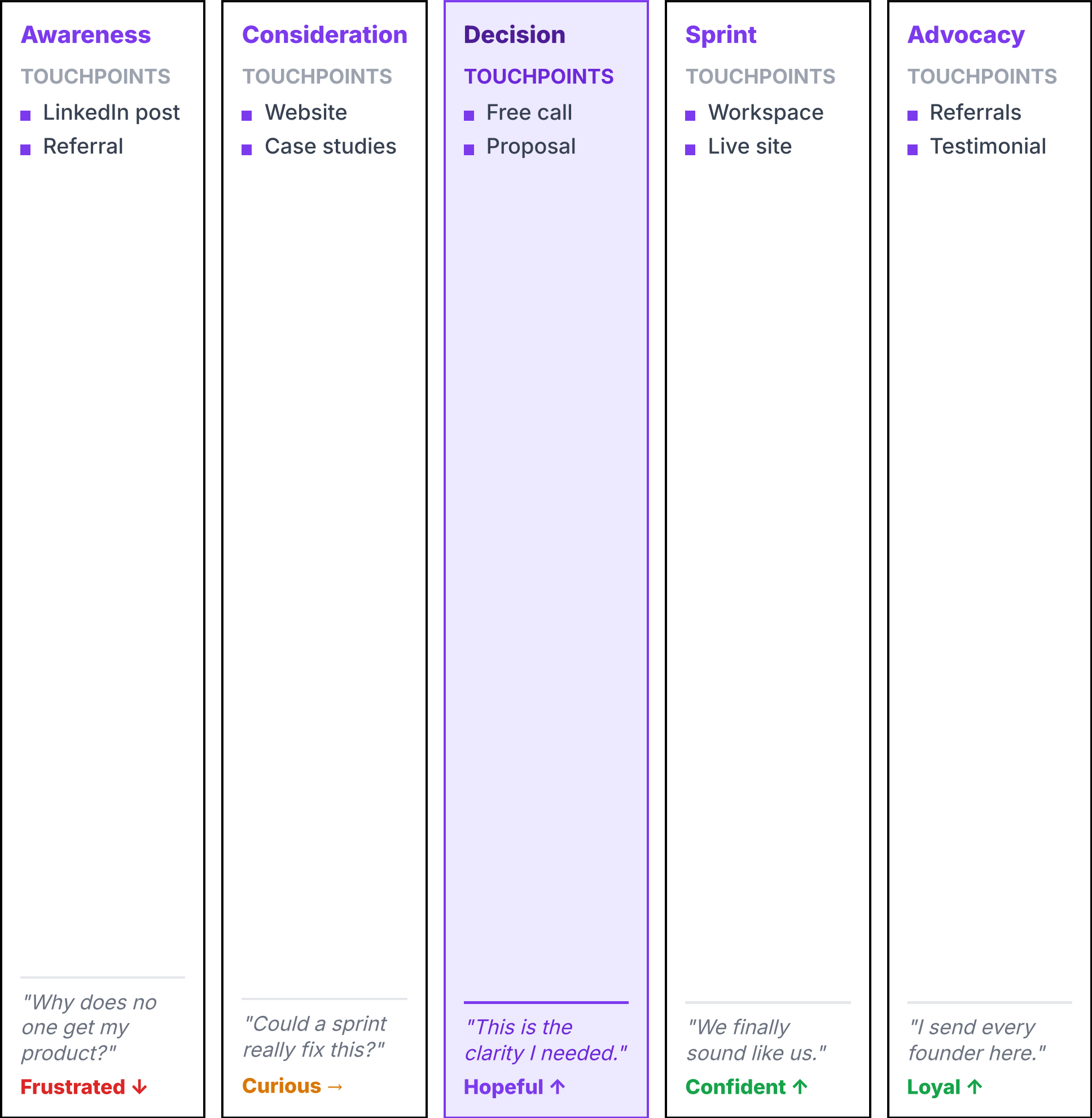
Deployment topology

Single primary region, multi-AZ data tier, warm standby for disaster recovery.

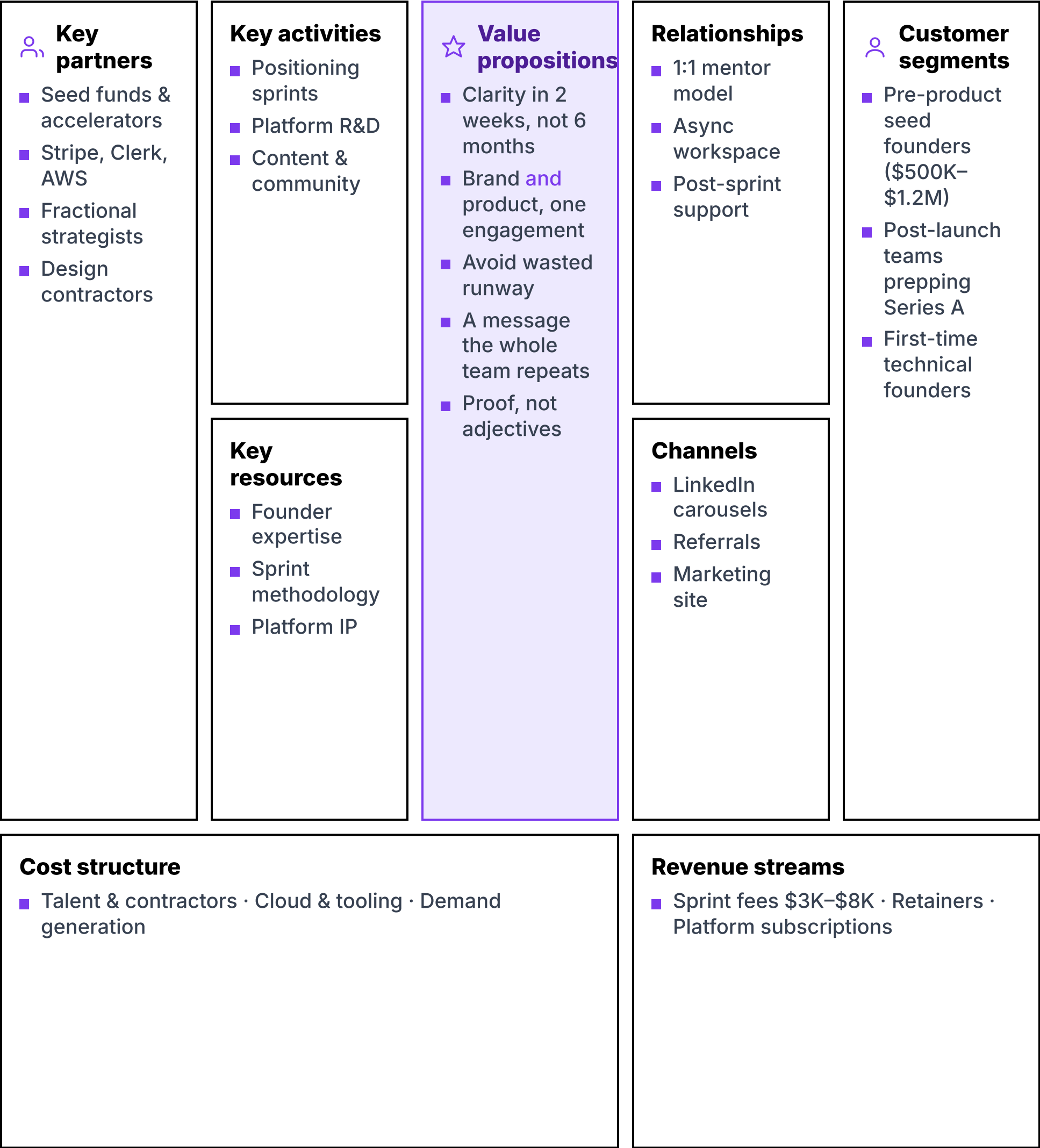


Founder journey map

Five stages from first touch to advocacy — mindset, emotion, and our move at each.

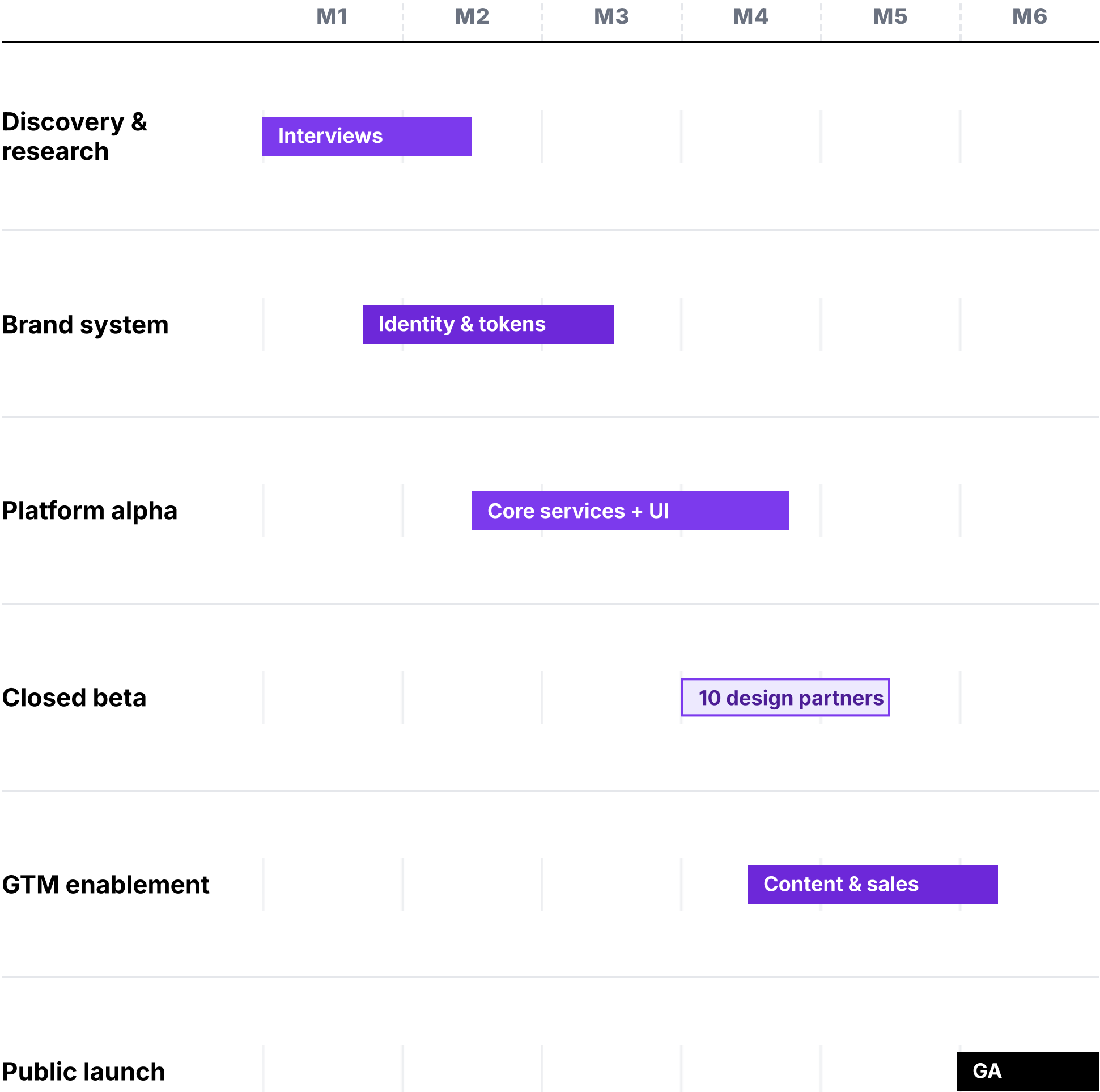


Business model canvas



Platform roadmap

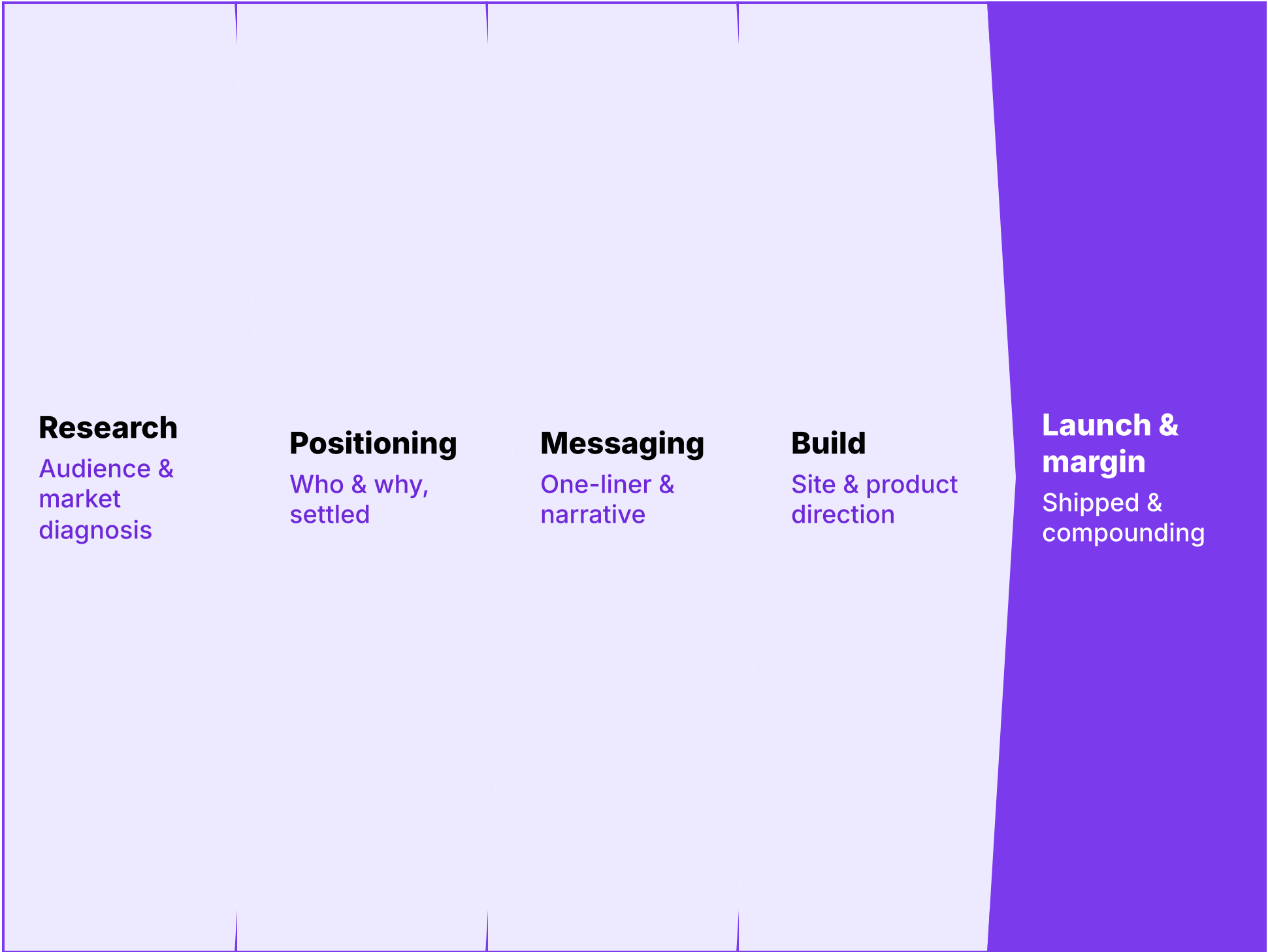
Six-month build plan across product and go-to-market workstreams.



Value chain

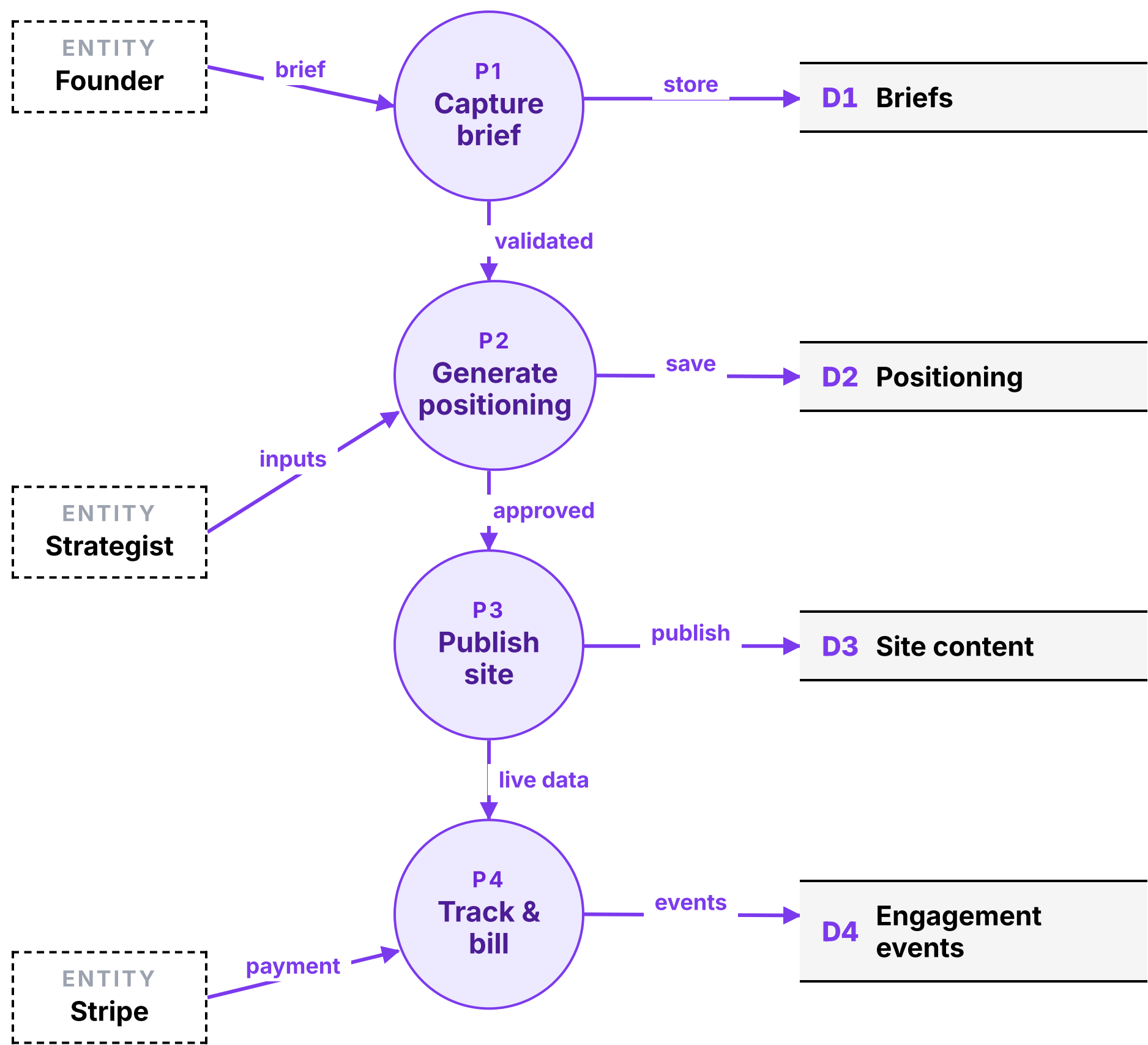
Support functions enable the primary flow that turns a founder's brief into margin.

Firm infrastructure	Brand strategy IP	Quality & delivery ops	Finance & legal
Technology & R&D	Positioning engine	Platform & automation	Analytics
People	Strategists	Designers & engineers	Community



Data flow diagram

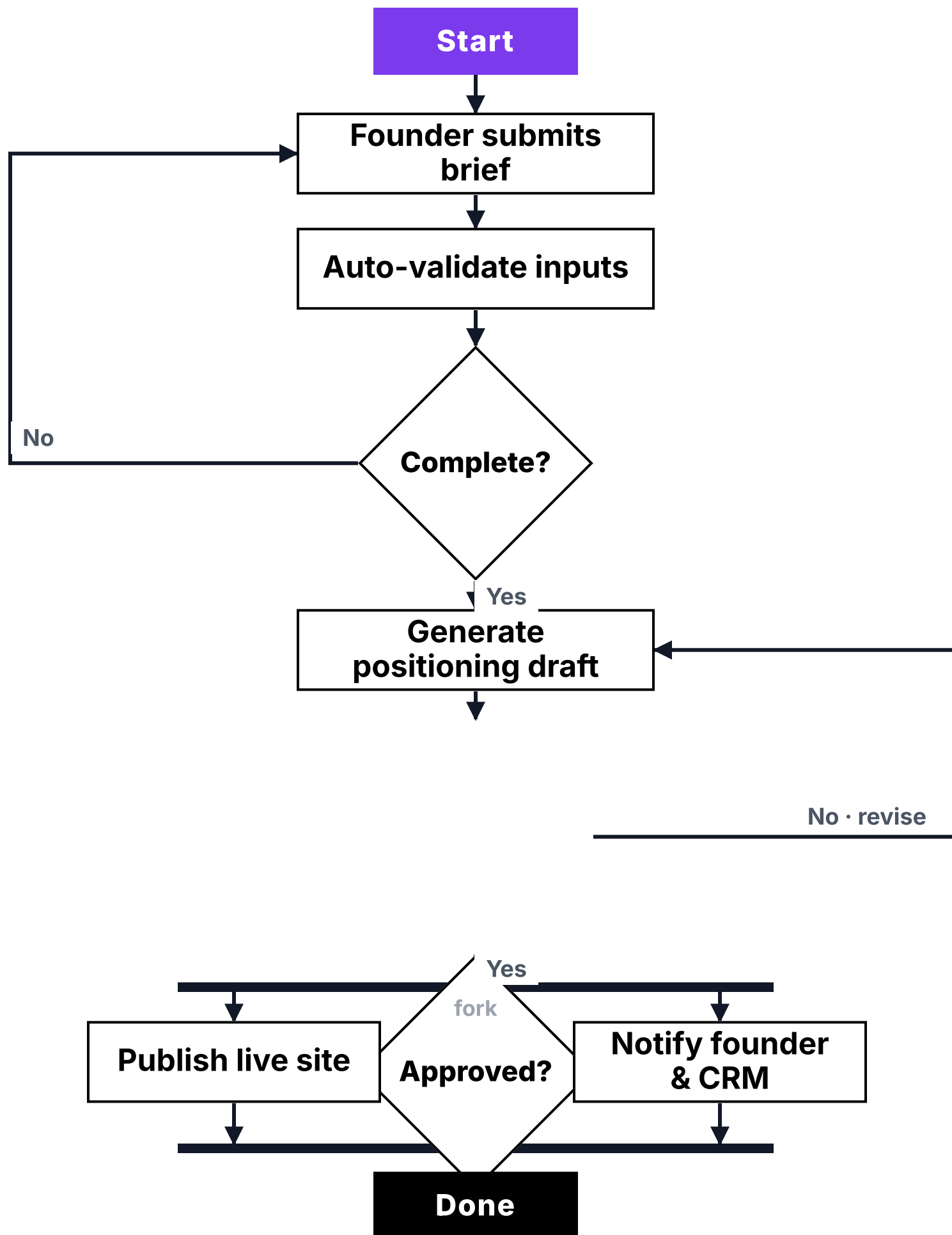
Entities, processes and stores for the brief-to-publish flow.



External entity Process Data store

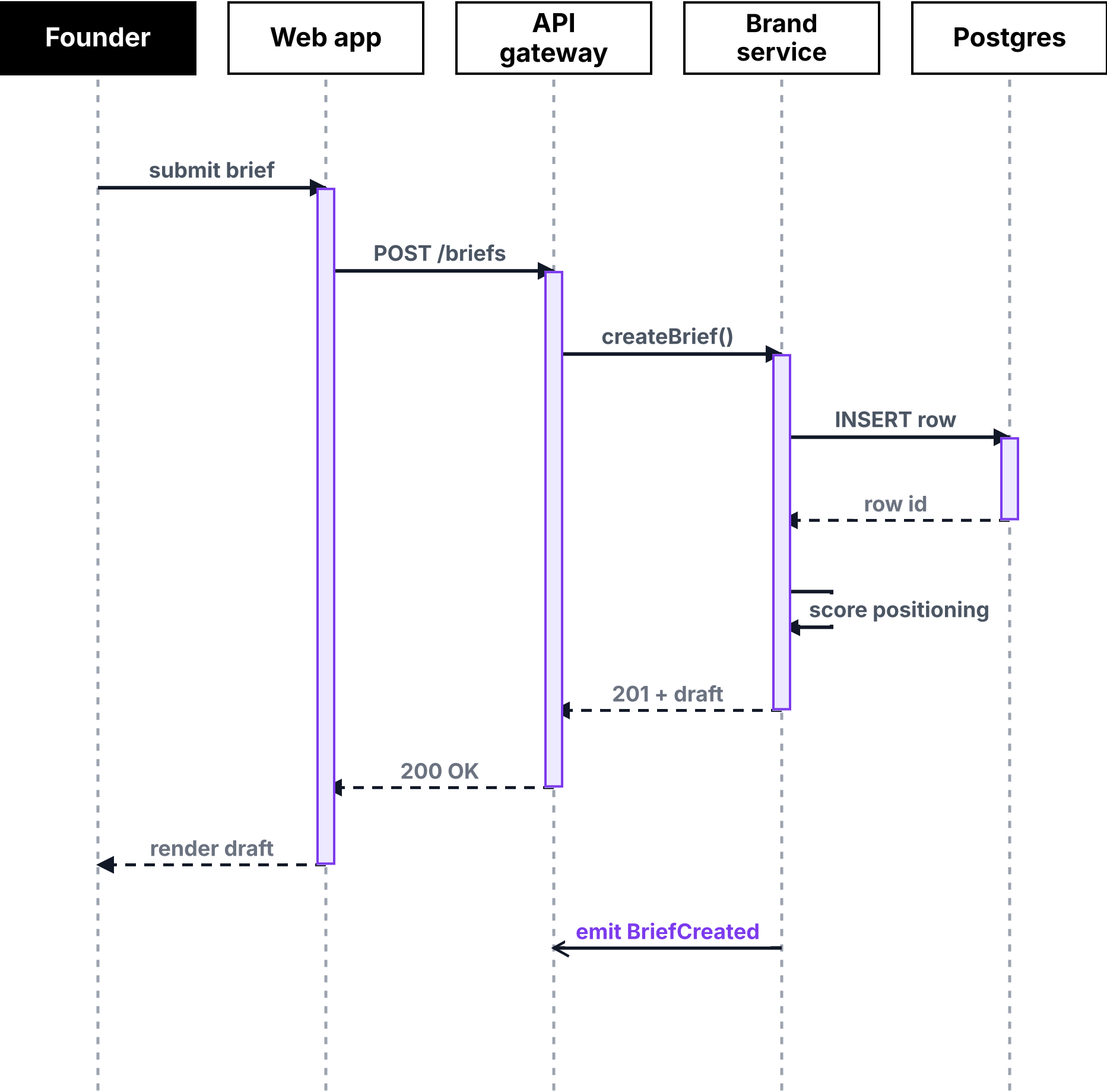
Activity diagram

The sprint workflow with validation loops and a parallel publish step.



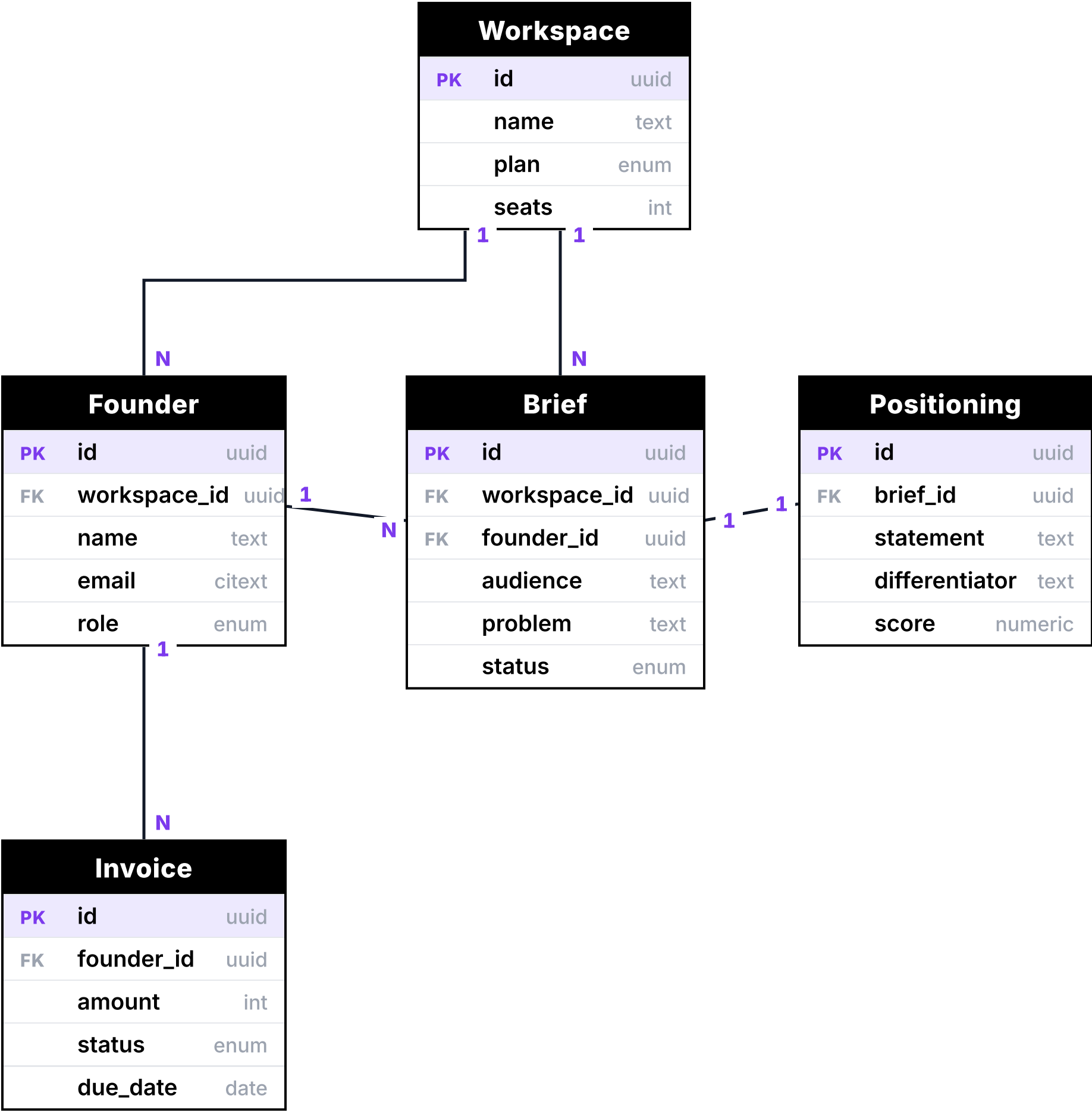
Sequence: create a brief

Request path and returns across the stack for a single brief submission.



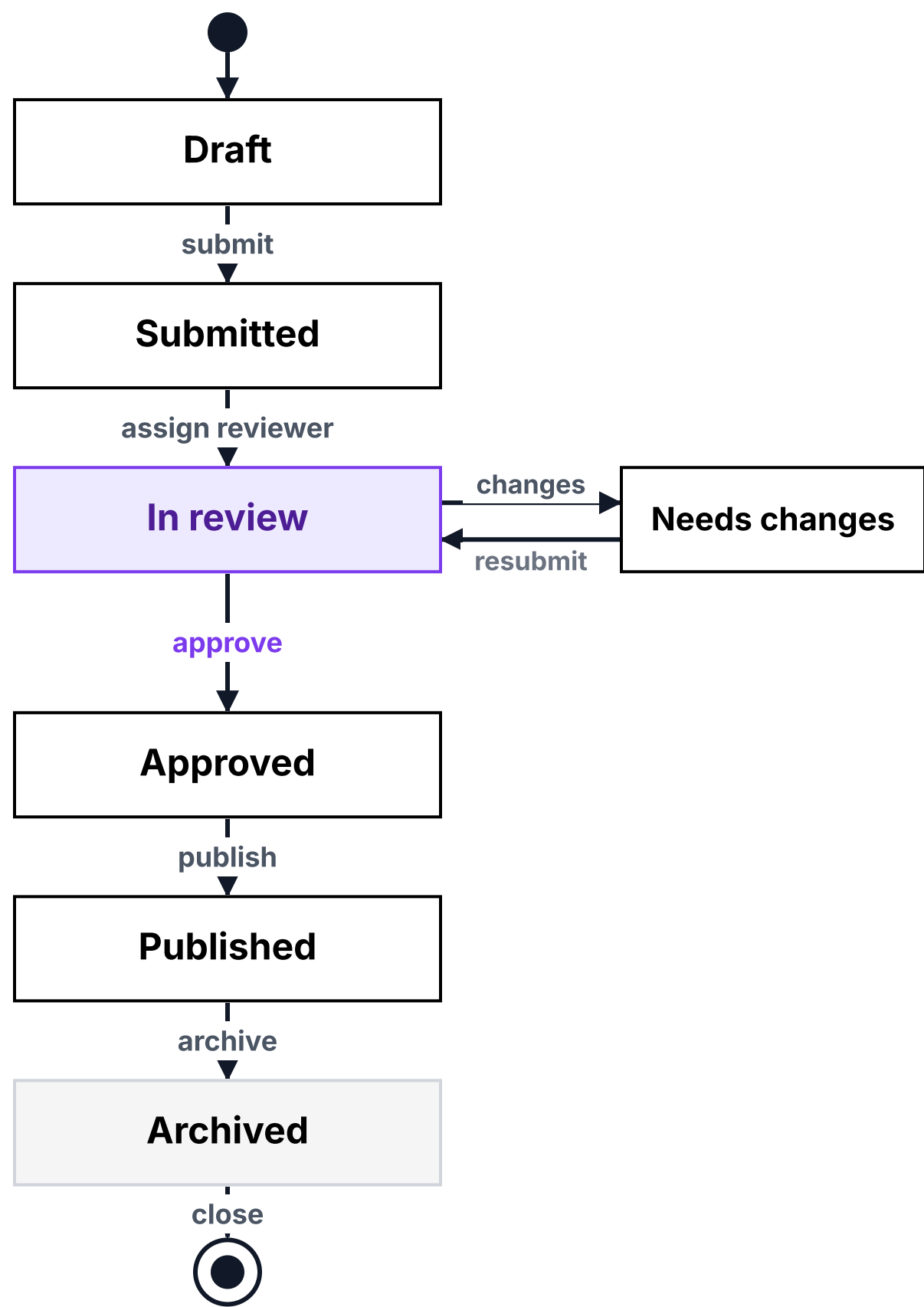
Entity-relationship model

Core tables and their keys — **PK** primary, **FK** foreign · 1 to N relations.



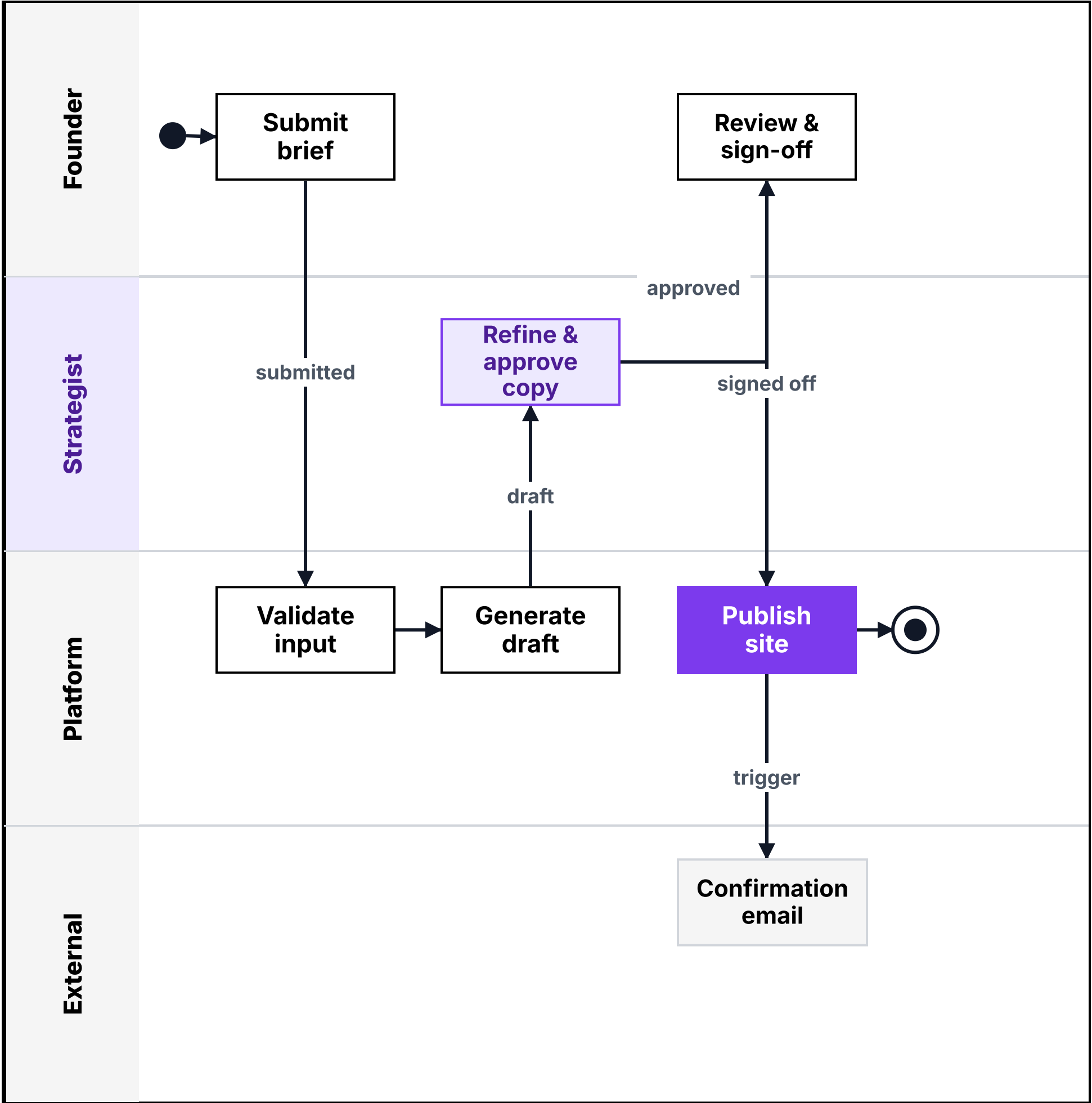
Brief state machine

Lifecycle of a brief from draft to archive, with a review rework loop.



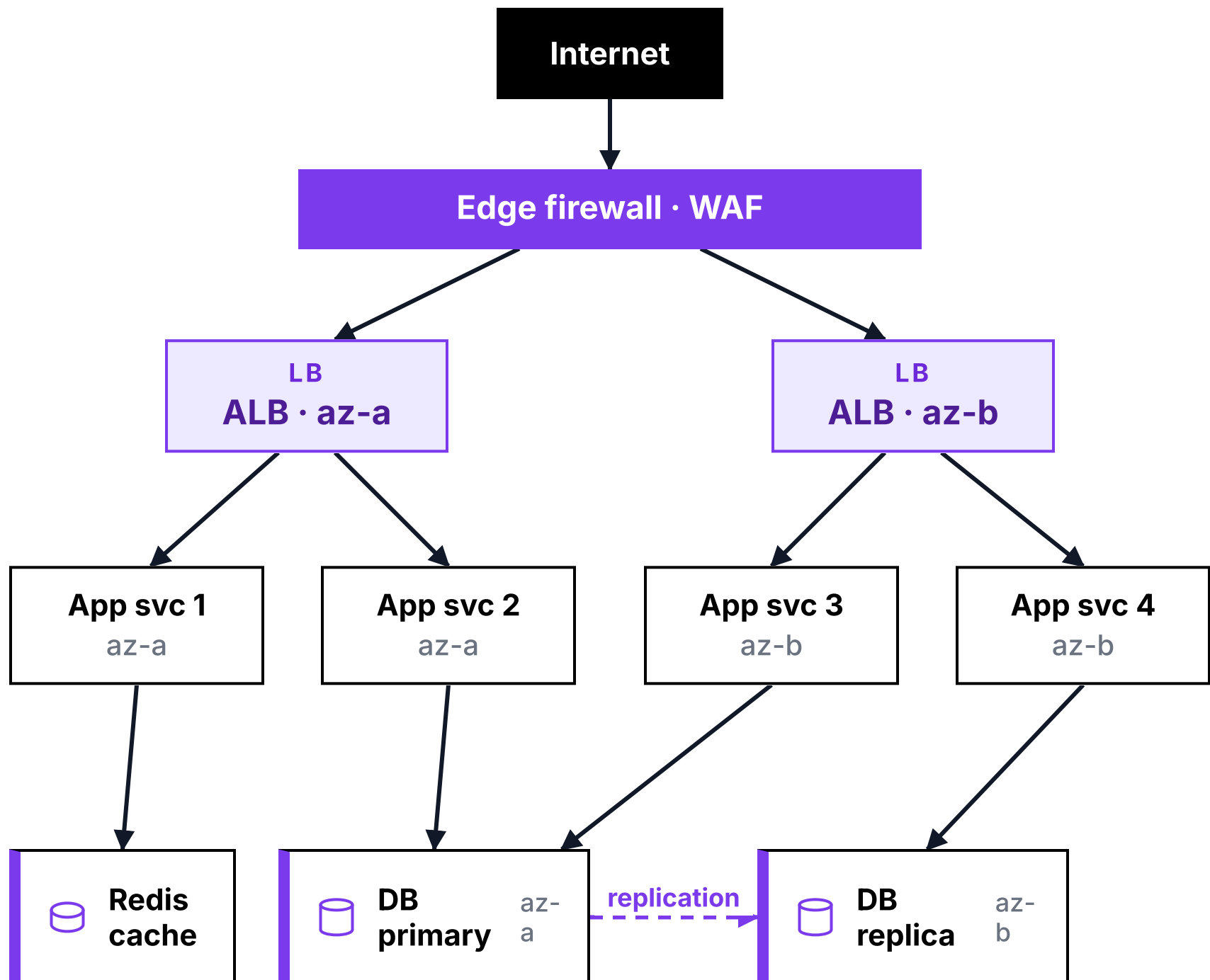
End-to-end sprint process

Who does what, in order — handoffs cross the lanes left to right.



Network topology

Redundant edge and app tiers across two availability zones with a replicated data tier.



■ Traffic path □ Replication □ Load balancer